

In fact, a good idea would be to turn off your AntiVirus program, screen saver, wallpaper, etc. (anything that might run in the background and disrupt the burning process). If you still encounter problems, you can lower the write speed.

8.6 Know When To Upgrade

Using the built-in CD-writing features in Windows XP is convenient, but this no-frills solution isn't enough for some demanding jobs. If you can answer yes to any of the following questions, you should begin looking into a more capable third-party CD-burning program:

- Do you want to create exact duplicates of data or music CDs? Windows Media Player forces you to copy the CD's contents to your hard disk first.
- Do you need to create ISO image files? As the name suggest, these files are perfect copies of a CD, which you can store on hard disk and use to make additional copies of a CD later. Windows XP can't create or copy ISO images, although the unauthorized ISO Recorder Power Toy can add this capability to Windows XP.
- Are you planning to make bootable CDs? Do you need to use disk formats other than standard data and audio formats, such as CD extra or Super Video CD? You'll need a program like Roxio's Easy CD Creator or Ahead Software's Nero to handle these chores.
- Do you want to use your CD-R or CD-RW drive as a backup device, with the option to compress files on the fly and span backups across multiple CDs? The newly released Nero 6.0 includes a serviceable backup utility, or you can invest in a dedicated backup utility.
- Do you want to record onto blank DVD disks using a recordable DVD drive? Windows XP can read and play back DVDs, but it can't record them.